

6.3 More Retouching Tools

Now come the big daddies of image repair tools! Photoshop CS2 has a lot of tools specifically meant to repair photographs and retouch imperfections. Let's start with the Healing Brush Tool.

The Healing Brush corrects imperfections, making them disappear into the surrounding image. Like the cloning tools, the Healing Brush tool paints with pixels sampled from an image or pattern, but the difference is that the Healing Brush matches the texture, lighting, transparency, and shading of the sampled pixels to the pixels being healed. Therefore, the repaired pixels seem to blend seamlessly into the rest of the image.

We've already shown you how to remove wrinkles using the Clone Stamp tool. Now it's time to do it in a better way—by using the Healing Brush tool. Ideally, you would use both the Clone Stamp and the Healing Brush to remove wrinkles—or imperfections in general.

What we've done is use the *Spot Healing tool* as well as the Healing tool to completely remove all traces of wrinkles on the old lady's face. The Spot Healing tool works just like the Healing tool, except that the pixels are sampled automatically, instead of you having to hold down [Alt], select an area to copy from and then proceed to use the Healing tool. Unfortunately, the Spot Healing tool is no good at the edges of the old woman's face, because it keeps selecting the woman's scarf instead of



Here's our favourite old lady back again



Here's what resulted from the Spot Healing and Healing tools